

User Experience and Design of UI and Services

UXI 2024/25 project

App for scheduling and managing services for negotiation professionals

team: **Just Join please**

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Project Goal

Our app **Bargiva** addresses the challenges faced by negotiation professionals and their clients in coordinating their services and sustaining effective collaboration. Specifically, we aimed to:

1. **Bridge the communication gap** between clients and negotiation professionals by providing a unified platform for chat and planning
2. **Streamline the scheduling process** for services such as sessions and workshops with easy to navigate calendar and schedule management
3. **Offer guided support** to clients via step-by-step tutorials, ensuring they are prepared even without directly communicating with the professional
4. **Quiz self-tests** provided by the professionals so the clients can verify their knowledge and improve their skills
6. **Transparency on service offerings** through clear descriptions and pricing, helping clients decide what service to they need
7. **Ensure scalability and adaptability** by designing a modular UI in Figma that can accommodate new services and advanced analytics features over time
8. **Test and feedback driven development** was prioritized to achieve a UI that is easy to navigate yet very informative, while still appealing to its users

User and Use Cases

Client's use cases:

- View available courses and services
- Sign up for a courses/services
- View and manage schedule
- Chat with the professional
- Learn from specific guides
- Test their knowledge with quizzes

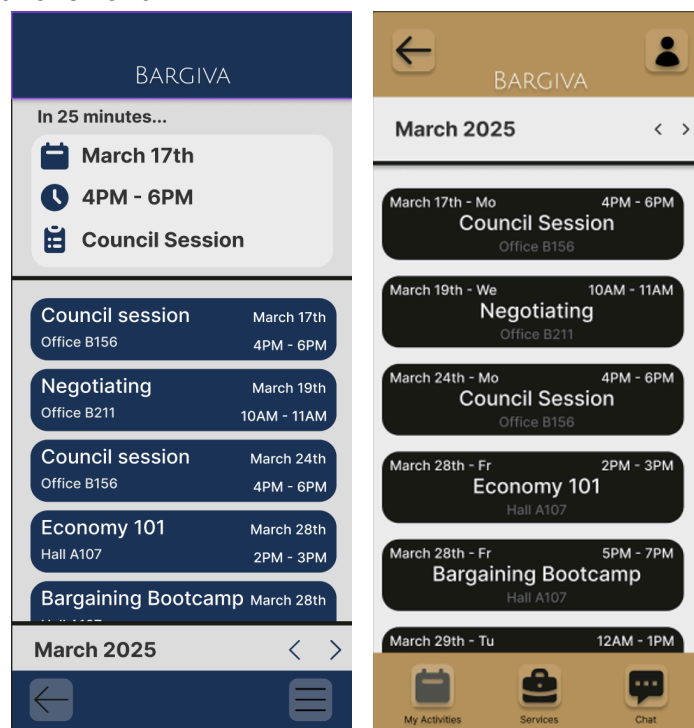
Professionals's use cases:

- Manage courses and services
- View and manage schedule
- Chat with the clients
- Manage guides
- Manage quizzes and see client's results

Important and Interesting Parts of the Project

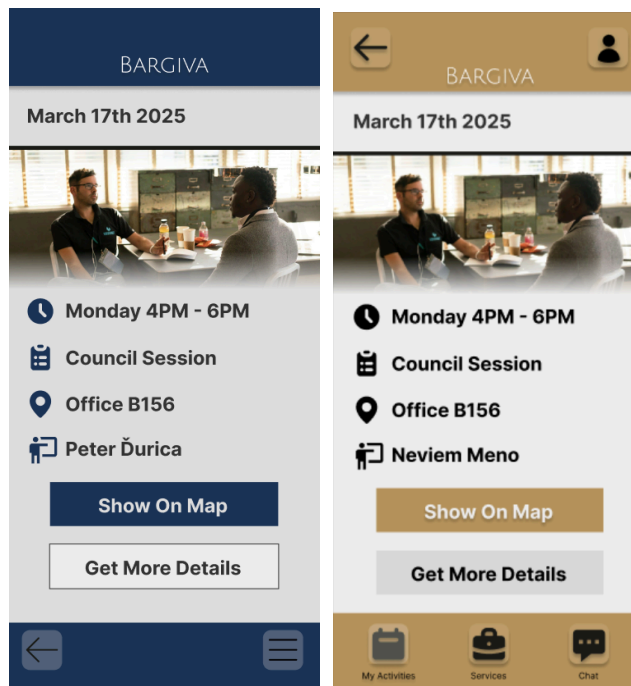
1. UI layout exploration

- **Why it mattered:** Testers told us the UI was confusing but couldn't say why or how to improve it, which was hard to fix, since we felt satisfied with it
- **What we did:** Sketched several designs, ran quick user satisfaction tests, then settled on a design that users liked and we were happy with
- **Outcome:** Clearer navigation, less buttons, less cognitive load on the user, easier to use even with one hand



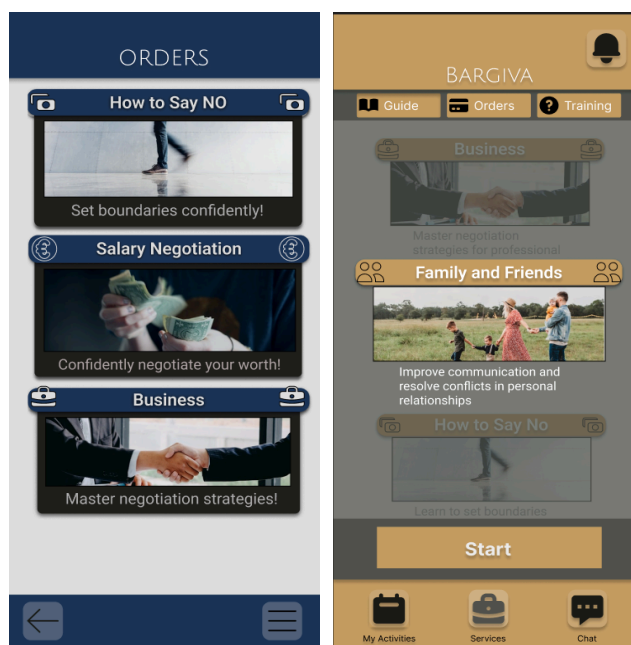
2. UI Color (psychological) testing

- **Why it mattered:** Color drives emotion — the testers didn't feel comfortable looking at our UI but also couldn't tell us which color would be better
- **What we did:** Showed users numerous color palettes, had them rate feelings (f.e. calm or energetic, professional or casual,..) and analyzed the feedback
- **Outcome:** Chose a deep blue primary with white, black and gray secondaries, which tested highest for professionalism, calmness and approachability



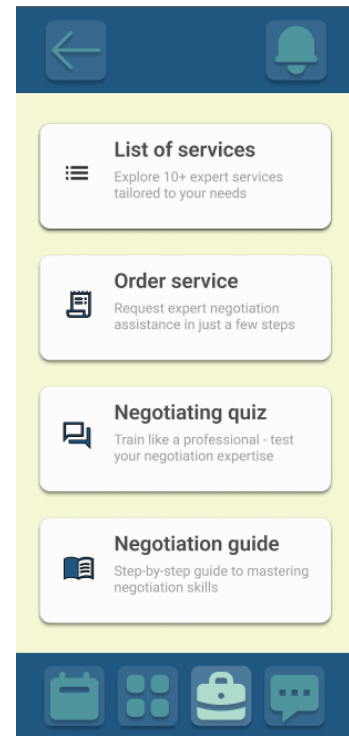
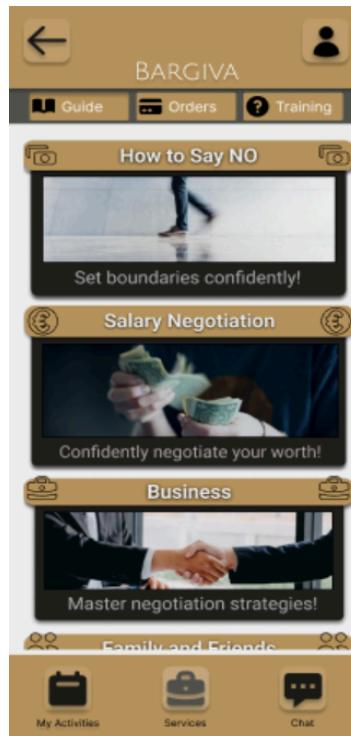
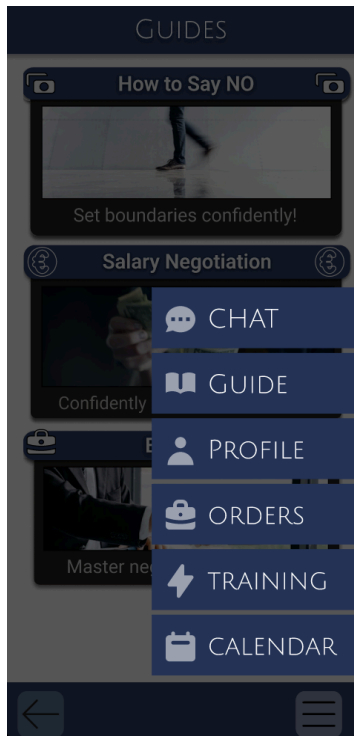
3. Reducing Cognitive Load

- **Why it mattered:** We as designers navigated easily, but new users felt overwhelmed by seeing too many options and buttons at the same time
- **What we did:** Simplified the navigation menu, used better and more symmetric content alignments and reduced the number of buttons and options the user saw on screen at any given time
- **Outcome:** UI now feels less cluttered and users reported significant improvement in terms of how the UI feels



4. Iterative, User-Centered improvements

- **Why it mattered:** Each iteration of testing and improving the UI revealed new issues
- **What we did:** Ran +-bi-weekly sessions with testers, logged every important point, applied numerous changes and improvements until the testers were satisfied
- **Outcome:** A polished UI that balances features and context with clear and intuitive navigation



Used Technologies and Tools

- Figma (www.figma.com)
- MS Teams (teams.microsoft.com)
- Google Docs (docs.google.com)
- App Diagrams (app.diagrams.net)
- Discord

Design Preliminaries

- UXIa courses and information presented in the lecture, including the students presentations such as
 - Psychology principles in UX/UI by Michaela Macková
 - The Psychology of Color in UI Design: Influencing User Behavior by Leopold Fuchs
 - Embracing Constraints in UI Design by Milan Tichavský
- Inspiration taken from established popular apps
 - such as Duolingo for its educational aspect
 - or [Booking.com](https://www.booking.com) for their ease of use
- Most important driving factor for us however was the feedback from potential users

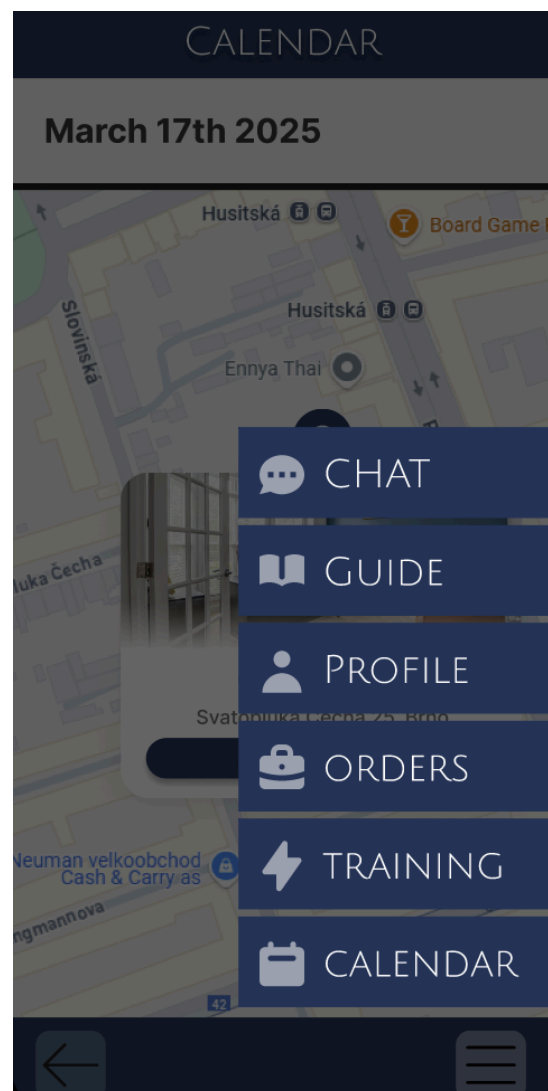
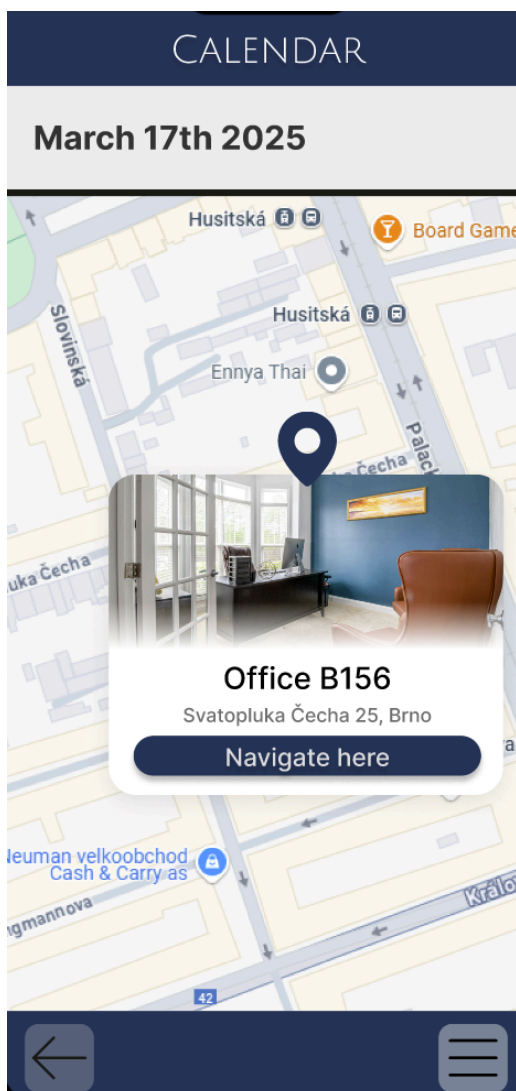
Testing

- **Phase 1**
 - Conducted a three one-hour session with potential users
 - Used a basic wireframe prototype created in Figma
 - Participants were asked to complete core tasks such as...
 - Find out what is your upcoming meeting
 - Find out where it takes place and when
 - Order a service
 - Watch lesson online
 - And more
 - Resulting feedback was clear: we have no idea what customer wants
 - For example, they were in no need for a streaming service, they are convinced it would cheapen their product
 - There are not many teachers, there are no teachers, there is only one negotiation professional who takes care of everything, all needs to be tailored to that single individual
- **Phase 2**
 - Conducted 5 qualitative usability testing sessions with users aged 18–44
 - As before, we gave potential users tasks to complete
 - Testing uncovered a variety of problems:
 - Many users struggled to navigate the interface without guidance
 - Turns out out previous iteration where we tried to gamify certain aspects of the application, it was completely detrimental to the user experience, so we had to take a step back from this
- **Phase 3**
 - No formal validation or follow-up testing was conducted after implementing the changes from Phase 2, due to the customer being too occupied with their business
 - We still asked to validate, which will hopefully take place beyond this course

- This hopefully would turn into a real product, useful and something we can be proud of

Most Important Achieved Results

- **User satisfaction:** Achieving purely positive feedback from test users was our single most important result. This required extensive time and numerous design iterations, but ultimately paid off
- **Elegant, streamlined navigation:** We introduced a new navigation style that's both elegant and intuitive, replacing our earlier, cluttered menu. This single, but crucial change eliminated visual clutter and significantly reduced cognitive load.
- **Activity section:** We're especially proud of the redesigned Activity section, where users can view their schedule alongside an interactive map pin. This feature provides additional details and seamless integration with external map applications like Google Maps



Distribution of the Work in the Team

The work was well balanced between all members of the team. Since we all had different schedules, sometimes one person worked more than others, then vice versa. Our “time-debt” on the project was paid by all roughly the same

What Was the Biggest Challenge

Our biggest challenge was uncovering what users truly needed and translating those needs into a UI that was easy, intuitive, context-rich, and visually appealing. Because testers struggled to tell us the specific changes, we iterated through numerous wireframes and sketches, often resorting to unconventional out-of-the-box ideas. Each round of experimentation revealed subtle pain points we hadn’t anticipated, prompting further improvements.

At the same time, we faced Figma’s steep learning curve. Navigating its tools and adapting them to our workflow took considerable time and practice. Ultimately, we overcame these hardships and polished the prototype to satisfy our expectations.

Experience Gained From the Project

- We improved our teamwork and time-management skills by coordinating our busy schedules and iteratively refining the designs in each session
- We learned how to create intuitive, user-centered interfaces and adapt them based on real user feedback
- We discovered that users often can’t specify exact changes, instead, they describe their feelings, which we learned how to translate to real UI adjustments
- We improved in Figma’s harder to learn toolset, achieving a well designed and working application prototype
- We learned how to balance adding new functionalities and design while preserving existing features, ensuring we met user needs without compromising our core design

What we have Discovered

- First design iteration **can** and **will be improved** on greatly in future iterations even if you feel that the design is good.
- Testers **don’t** magically give you **perfect solutions** on how to better design your app. You need to provide them with **different choices** and then they will choose the one that is **intuitively best** for them.
- It’s **never too late** to iterate on a not perfect design.

- **Hardest part** is creating a **simple** design.
- UI elements in **well made** and **widely used** applications already passed through **excessive testing** and we **should take inspiration** from them in our own design elements.

Autoevaluation

Problem Selection: 70%

- The topic was chosen based on the real need for a product, which, arguably, is ideal
- On the other hand, the customer was too occupied with running their own business, thus probably not having enough resources to hire a professional team to do the app

Problem Analysis: 66%

- We had a strong vision at the beginning, however, turns out we had misunderstood the real users need, which made it difficult to find solutions at a reasonable pace
- But in the end we still came up with a solid design which is very likely easy to understand for the customer

Testing: 60%

- We had an opportunity to conduct just qualitative testing, but we wish we had an opportunity to do it more often or do some meaningful large-scale testing
- Most importantly, we couldn't validate the most final version appropriately yet, which we still plan to do
- Other than that, we carefully planned how it would go, prepared core tasks and arguments for the design, but most importantly, observed users behavior and iterated our project accordingly

UI Design: 70%

- Since the first iteration, we have come a long way to provide an app which gives off that correct business/corporate energy required in this field
- This includes colors, ease of access and as little visual clutter as possible, this is all important to people who lead stressful lives
- However, there is the aspect of flaws we don't see and have yet to uncover by testing and putting it to real use

Use of Resources: 66%

- At first, we tried being inventive and doing everything on our own, which resulted in not ideal design that needed a lot of rework.
- What we have learned during the lectures is that people have worked with UI for decades, we should take notes, see and use what works

Team Cooperation: 60%

- During the semester, we generally had a rough time keeping up with our own assignments, some did more than others
- However by the end, others caught up with their responsibilities and delivered, even though it was sometimes close to deadlines
- Thus overall, we came to terms despite each member having their own responsibilities and design ideas

Overall Impression: 69%

- Assignment was fair for a team of 4, executing it however wasn't as great since we sometimes disagreed on some parts of the design or were late to deliver in time due to weaker communication and time management
- We learned to value simplicity and details in UI, making us far likely to spot flaws in our future projects
- This project is a good reminder to never forget about the user when making a product

Recommendation for Assigning Future Projects

- We liked the **regular presentations** since it forced us to **always think** about the project. Since those presentations were in phases it also allowed us to **naturally develop a system** which allowed us to have a **certain amount of iterations** on all elements of our design.
- We've **never worked** in Figma before this course and even though there was a lecture about Figma, We still don't think **we properly used** all that Figma has to offer in the project. Maybe some **small exercises** throughout the semester on certain **important features** that not many students have used in their projects could be helpful.

Recommendation for Future Students

- **FIND A TEAM !** Make sure you have a team, ideally a team of students that you can trust to **not abandon you** during a semester.
- Find a **good topic** for your project. Something with **not that many features** so that you can **focus on specific** problems and **not be spread too thin**.
- Find an **already existing app** or design language that you can **take inspiration from**.
- **Communicate** with your team. **Delegate jobs** and make sure that all team members **know what they are doing**. If they have trouble with something then **help them**. The next presentation is always close so you **don't really have time to get stuck**.

- **Before the presentation** connect with all members of your team and create the presentation **together**. Make sure that **all members know** what you will be presenting and what all members will be talking about.
- The **sooner** you submit your presentation, the **sooner** you will present it at the lecture. Use that information how you see fit.

Figma Prototype

[Link to Figma Prototype](#)

- If you run a prototype without selecting a specific page, you will have to complete a “Setting Up” section before you can fully access the application.
- Navigation is implemented by the button at the right bottom of the screen. If you press it, you can see all sections of the app and then select which section you want to navigate to.
- App is divided into two modes. First is a client mode which is default at the start, and the second is the professional mode. You can change between these modes in the “Profile” section. To change the mode you click on the profile picture of the currently logged in user.